THE LOCH NESS MONSTER

Loch Ness is an immensely deep lake in the northeastern Highlands of Scotland. It is overlooked by brooding hills and wild moorland - the perfect setting for strange and unexplained events. In 1933, a motorist on the new lakeside road saw a tremendous upheaval in the loch*. The waters churned and boiled as a huge monster, its body the size of a whale, broke the surface. The incident was reported in the local paper, and soon the national press was buzzing with news of what came to be called "The Loch Ness Monster." But legends of large water creatures in Loch Ness go back much further than 1933. In the 6th century AD, the Irish missionary Saint Columba was said to have banished a monster which had attacked a swimmer. And local folk tales, going back centuries, speak of "water horses" and "water bulls" inhabiting Loch Ness. Scientists have seriously suggested that large creatures may have been stranded in the loch, when 60 million years ago it was cut off from the sea. Perhaps their descendants live there still. But despite hazy photographs, mostly highly magnified, of strange "humps" in the water, there is very little evidence, as yet, to go on.

*The Scottish word for "lake".

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

COLUMN A **COLUMN B**

a) have a view of from above .....

b) threatening; causing one to feel nervous .....

c) open, uncultivated area of land, usually high .....

d) disturbance .....

e) move or stir violently .....

f) bubble; show a lot of activity .....

g) send away and not allow to return, as a

punishment .....

h) be unable to leave a place; be stuck .....

i) not clear or distinct .....

j) make bigger (in appearance) .....

k) round lumps, (e.g. on the back of a camel) .....

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. The legends about the Loch Ness Monster. . . . . .

A) were first reported in 1933
B) stem from the times when water bulls and horses lived in the loch
C) are based on scientific evidence
D) originated hundreds of years ago
E) were passed on by Irish missionaries

2. We can infer that Loch Ness. . . . . .

A) is full of the descendants of large creatures
B) used to be connected to the sea
C) is very popular with photographers
D) usually has hazy weather
E) is deeper than most other lakes

3. According to the writer, ...

A) monsters have lived in Loch Ness for 60 million years
B) the water in Loch Ness is a very high temperature
C) nobody has actually seen the Loch Ness monster
D) the Loch Ness monster looks like a whale
E) the surroundings of Loch Ness are the ideal location for unusual happenings

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. When we ran out of money on holiday we thought we would……, but fortunately we were able to borrow some to pay for our journey home.
2. The worst thing about moving house is all the……it causes. It takes ages to get things back into order.
3. The room we had in the hotel had a lovely, large balcony……the sea.
4. It was a really……day, so we could hardly see the mountains on the other side of the bay.
5. When studying the cells of a plant in biology, you have to……the images several times so that they can be seen clearly.